RESEARCH FRAMEWORK / TECHNOLOGY

AI and Technology Trend Scan

A source-aware framework for screening technology developments and evaluating their possible relevance without presenting early claims as forecasts.

01 Executive summary

A commissioned report would summarise the decision being considered, the scope examined, the most relevant evidence-backed observations, the main uncertainties, and the next decision points.

This illustrative document demonstrates a summary format only. It does not report actual market findings, verified organisations, client results, or recommendations about a real business.

* Decision question and intended audience
* Scope and evidence base reviewed
* Key observations with confidence and limitations
* Prioritised areas for further consideration

02 Illustrative research question

How can a business screen technology developments for relevance and decide what warrants further investigation?

03 Hypothetical context

Hypothetical demonstration: a B2B service team is reviewing whether to investigate selected AI-enabled workflow tools. No technology capability, vendor claim, or market outcome is asserted as fact here.

DEMONSTRATION ONLY

No actual findings, clients, or sources are presented.

04 Scope and methodology

A live engagement would state the agreed market or organisation boundaries, geographic coverage, time period, included and excluded questions, source types, and analytical approach.

Research steps should be proportionate to the decision and evidence available. This demonstration describes a possible report structure, not research performed against real organisations or sources.

* Research question and decision context
* Scope, inclusion criteria, and exclusions
* Public and client-supplied evidence distinguished
* Review period and analysis approach

05 Findings and analysis

A completed report would distinguish observed information from analyst interpretation and hypotheses. Each material finding would be connected to evidence and assessed against the agreed question.

No real findings, comparisons, scores, market sizes, or business outcomes are asserted in this illustrative sample.

* Observed evidence and its source
* Interpretation and relevance to the decision
* Counter-signals, confidence, and open questions
* No unsupported statistics or inferred private performance

06 Evidence and source notes

For a real research engagement, a source log can record the publisher, title, publication date, retrieval date, URL or document reference, geographic coverage, relevant claim, and known limitations.

This demonstration intentionally does not cite external sources or present its example material as verified evidence.

* Publisher and source title
* Publication and retrieval dates
* URL or document reference and supported claim
* Source quality, coverage, and known limitations

07 Limitations and uncertainties

A research report should explain information gaps, source coverage, recency, conflicting claims, assumptions, and areas requiring further validation.

This illustrative document cannot establish actual demand, market size, competitor performance, partner willingness, or future results.

* Evidence gaps and unverified assumptions
* Source and geographic coverage
* Areas where additional research may be appropriate
* No guarantee of commercial or operational outcomes

08 Recommendations

Recommendations in a live report should follow from documented evidence and the agreed decision criteria. Their rationale, dependencies, and uncertainties should remain visible.

No real-world recommendations or outcomes are claimed in this illustrative document.

* Prioritised recommendations tied to the research question
* Evidence rationale and uncertainty for each action
* Dependencies, owners, or timing only where agreed

09 Proposed next steps

Potential next steps may include gathering additional evidence, testing a defined hypothesis, consulting relevant specialists, or reviewing specified indicators.

A live engagement would agree responsibilities, timing, and review points with the client. This demonstration does not claim that any action has been taken or that an outcome is assured.

* Identify the most important unresolved question
* Agree what additional evidence would help answer it
* Set proportionate review points and decision criteria
* Revisit conclusions as relevant evidence changes

10 Decision context and horizon

Begin with a specific business workflow, strategic decision, audience, and review horizon. A general request to assess AI is too broad to produce a useful, bounded scan.

Record current processes, constraints, risk tolerance, data considerations, and decision owners as supplied context. Keep that information distinct from externally researched evidence.

* Workflow or business question under review
* Decision horizon and intended audience
* Operational and data constraints
* Out-of-scope technologies or uses

11 Technology and claim taxonomy

Group developments into relevant capability or application themes and describe each claim precisely. Distinguish product availability, stated vendor capability, independently demonstrated performance, and analyst interpretation.

Record the source publisher, date, context, and claim. A demonstration, benchmark, launch announcement, and customer case study have different evidential roles.

* Capability or application category
* Claim type and attribution
* Publication date and context
* Evidence needed to verify business relevance

12 Evidence quality and uncertainty

Review sources for attribution, methodology, recency, independence, scope, and incentives. Note where claims are self-reported, where methods are unclear, and where evidence cannot be independently checked.

Technology changes quickly. Capture the review date and avoid translating a short-term signal into a prediction or adoption recommendation without suitable evidence.

* Source register and review date
* Independent corroboration where available
* Claim limitations and missing information
* Uncertainty and update triggers

13 Business relevance assessment

Compare candidate developments against agreed practical criteria such as relevance to the workflow, feasibility of evaluation, data sensitivity, integration dependency, governance requirement, and potential user impact.

Use a simple qualitative screen to identify questions for further assessment. A scan is not an implementation design, procurement recommendation, or security review.

* Business problem alignment
* Evidence strength and uncertainty
* Operational dependencies and governance questions
* Possible low-risk evaluation steps

14 Illustrative synthesis format

A decision brief may present a theme map, source and claim register, potential implications, evidence limitations, and questions for a technical or operational review. This demonstration contains no real vendor evaluations or trend findings.

Any recommendation should state the evidence and assumptions behind it and identify which specialist review is needed before procurement or deployment.

* What the scan reviewed and when
* Claims that remain unverified
* Potential business implications to investigate
* Questions for technical, legal, privacy, and security specialists

15 Limitations and potential outputs

Emerging technology claims can change rapidly, be difficult to reproduce, and omit context relevant to a specific business. Public materials alone cannot establish suitability, safety, compliance, or return on investment.

Potential outputs include a technology scan, a claim/source register, relevance questions, a limitation log, and a shortlist of issues for specialist assessment.

* Not a forecast or investment recommendation
* Not technical, legal, privacy, or security assurance
* No adoption or performance guarantee
* Review and update cadence agreed separately